

ENGINE FIX • ACCENT / ON-ACCENT PAIRING

Text that survives a pale accent.

Every accent-filled surface now pairs with its curated `--on-accent` ink — readable on a near-black lime, a warm cream, or a cool slate, in both modes.

DECISION REQUIRED

Build the data layer or buy it?

Both paths are viable. The difference is where we spend the next 18 months.

BUILD IN-HOUSE

- Full control over schema and roadmap
- 2–3 engineer-quarters to reach feature parity
- Ongoing maintenance burden stays internal

BUY + CONFIGURE



- Ship in 6 weeks, not 9 months
- Engineering capacity redirects to product features
- Exit risk manageable — export contractually guaranteed

RECOMMENDATION

Buy the infrastructure. Build the differentiation. Revisit in 24 months.

The fix has four moving parts.

1

One source of truth

--on-accent is curated per theme for AAA contrast against that theme's accent, in both light and dark.

2

Derived muted tiers

Secondary, ghost, and watermark inks mix down from --on-accent by opacity — no white-on-pale collisions.

3

Consumers realigned

The verdict bar and pinned tag now read the pair instead of a fixed light ink.

4

Projected to the web

The site palette generator ships --on-accent, so the landing CTA matches the deck.

How the accent ink resolves.





The accent rail proves it

Where the pairing shows

The left rail fills with the raw accent. Its eyebrow rides `--on-accent` at full strength and the letterform watermark rides `--on-accent-watermark`, so the rail stays legible on a pale canvas.

- 1

Eyebrow

Reads at `--on-accent` — the curated ink itself. A muted derivation would spend the AA margin that curation buys, so size and weight carry the step down instead.
- 2

Watermark

The oversized glyph sits at 12% and never fights the content.
- 3

Numerals

Each counter chip fills with accent and stamps `--on-accent`.

ONE PAIR, EVERY PALETTE

Curated once. Readable everywhere.

KEY INSIGHT

Reuse the ink the theme already trusts.